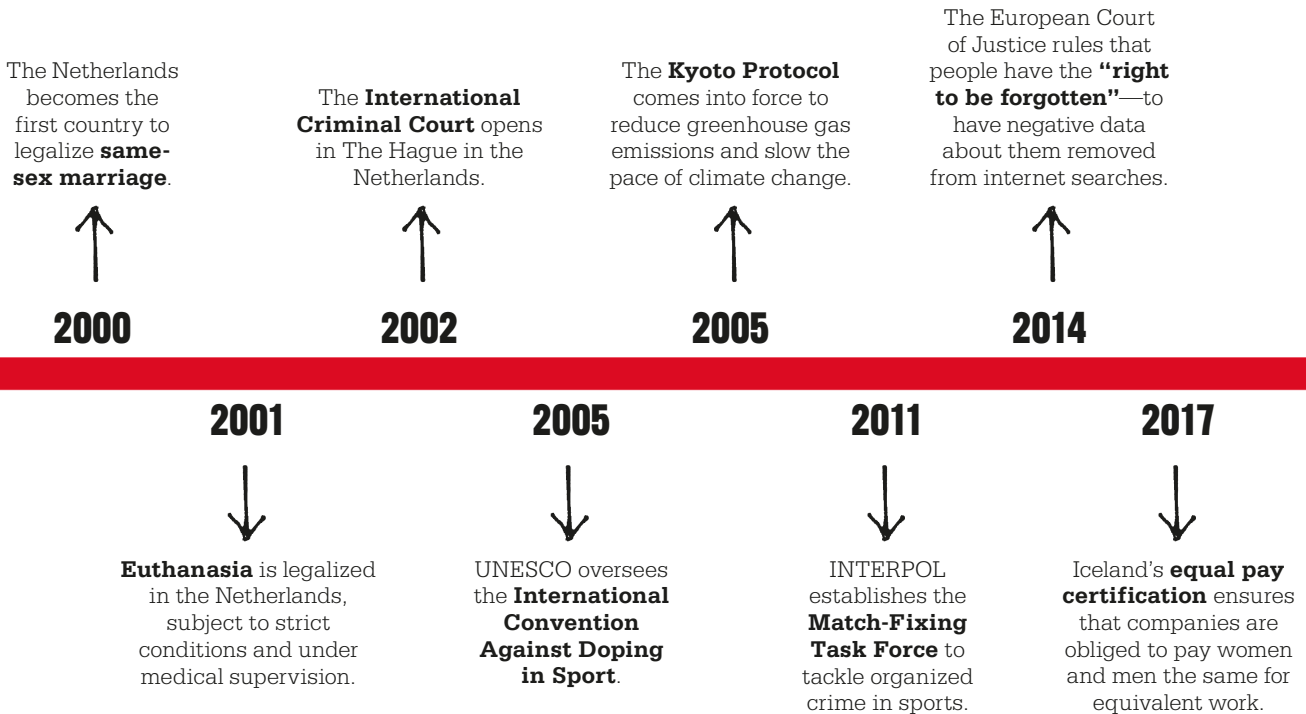




The law is also grappling with new ethical issues, including those raised by human embryo research and by the suffering of terminally ill people.

The fight against crime

Advances in science can often pose ethical problems, but science has also been invaluable in securing the evidence to ensure justice is served. DNA profiling to identify criminals proved to be as crucial a forensic tool as fingerprinting, while digital technology became indispensable in every aspect of law enforcement, especially given the increasing sophistication and international scope of organized crime.

The world of sports experienced significant change, too, with the increase in global sponsorship, live television coverage, and online gambling multiplying the financial

stakes. As the industry expanded, corruption increased—the rewards of cheating lured individuals, crime rings, and rogue nations alike. UNESCO moved to stem the tide with the International Convention Against Doping in Sport in 2005, and in 2011, INTERPOL set up a task force to combat match fixing.

In 2000, alarmed at the rate of new HIV/AIDS cases—half of which arose from injecting drugs—the Portuguese government put in place a new drug strategy, decriminalizing the possession of drugs as part of wider health and social reforms whose impact other countries are now studying.

Protecting the planet

By the 1980s, the damaging effects of human activity on the natural world were clear, and the issue won

space on the international agenda. In 1983, UNESCO led the way in environmental protection, with the creation of a network of Biosphere Reserves to foster conservation and sustainable development.

An even bigger problem is the potentially catastrophic effects of global climate change. In 1992, the Rio Earth Summit adopted international goals for the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions, but a reluctance to implement change and adopt sustainable energy policies prevented any legally binding agreement until the 21st century. In 1997, the Kyoto Protocol defined targets for the reduction of emissions, which came into force in 2005. Given our failure to enact reduction policies, the challenge for law is to find new ways to ensure everyone does their part. ■